

Lab 6: Information Gathering: Unobtrusive Methods

IUTian Threads by Team System322

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1. Sampling Strategy

Populations Considered: - Students - Faculty Members - University Administration Staff

Chosen Population: - Students

Method: Complex Random - Stratified Sampling

Justification for Stratified Method: - Ensures representation of key subgroups (academic year, department, residential status). - Captures diverse user needs across subgroups. - Reduces sampling bias by ensuring equal representation from each subgroup. - Facilitates deeper analysis and more effective follow-up on subgroup-specific details.

1. Sampling Strategy: Steps (Blueprint from Lecture)

Define Data: - Investigating students' communication preferences, satisfaction with current methods, and expectations from a dedicated university forum.

Define Population: - All students enrolled at the university across all departments and years.

Select Sample Type: - Stratified sampling to ensure representation across key student demographics.

Decide Sample Size: - Determined based on the desired confidence level (95%) and an acceptable margin of error (± 0.05), using statistical calculations.

Division of Population into Strata: - Group students by identified categories (academic year, department, residential status).

Obtain Sampling Frame: - Proportionally determine how many students to select from each subgroup based on their actual representation.

Random Selection per Stratum: - Utilize random number generator software to select students within each subgroup.

Invitation to Selected People: - Contact students via university emails and official messaging platforms.

Documentation: - Record details of strata definitions, sampling sizes, methods of selection, and response rates.

1. Investigation Plan for Existing Data

Existing Data Sources: - Performance Reports (Quantitative) - Communication logs tracking response times and query resolutions. - Records (Quantitative) - Frequency and types of student queries received,

categorized by topic and urgency. - Admin Feedback Forms (Qualitative) - Comments and suggestions regarding communication issues and effectiveness.

1. Insights from Existing Data

Recurring Issues Identified: - High volume of repetitive inquiries. - Inefficient tracking and follow-up mechanisms. - Lack of structured communication leading to delayed resolutions.

Thematic Patterns: - Strong need for organized query management systems. - Demand for categorization, searchability, and effective notification mechanisms.

Feature Requests: - Thread management with detailed categorization. - Automated notification system for updates and replies. - Voting mechanisms for prioritizing important issues.

1. Analyst's Playscript

Actor (Role)	Information-Related Activity
Student	Submits posts, queries, feedback anonymously or publicly
Moderator	Reviews content, flags issues, engages directly with posts
Administrator	Reviews summarized communication reports, manages policy implementation
Faculty Member	Responds to department-specific queries and discussions
IT Support	Ensures system maintenance, resolves technical issues, manages authentication systems

1. STROBE Observations

STROBE Element	Observation
Location	Digital platform hosted on secure university servers, accessible remotely
Interface Layout	Organized forum with clearly defined categories by department and issue
Interaction Tools	Discussion threads, voting and reaction options, notification systems, and effective search functionality
External Integrations	Integration with university's authentication and email notification systems

1. Key Organizational Themes Observed:

2. Structured, centralized communication preferred over informal, cluttered platforms
3. Importance placed on moderated, secure interactions
4. High user demand for mobile access and immediate notifications
5. Necessity of authenticated, secure access to ensure data integrity

6. Anecdotal Observations:

7. Students often express frustration with cluttered informal platforms.
8. Moderators highlight the inefficiencies of manual moderation tasks.

9. Administrators express strong concerns about data security and content appropriateness.

Thank you! Feel free to ask any questions.